

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

iWord, Anyone?

In the beginning was the Word. Next comes the iPod. It beats us why so many of God's People have taken such a fancy to Apple's player, but "popularity" probably has something to do with it.

So what's in the news now? Head to www.bibleplayer.com. They've taken Romans 10:17 literally: "So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God."

Their pitch? "This unique MP3 audio Bible lets you take God's Word with you anywhere you go. Using iPod's 'Notes' feature, you can read and hear the Bible on your iPod. Each Book is logically organised, so finding the chapter you want is a breeze."

This is the first version of the Bible designed specifically for the iPod. Has the *Book of Job* morphed into the *Book of Jobs*?

Bill's Bucks!

Bill Gates has said the US tax office has to store his financial data on a "special" computer. "My tax return in the United States has to be kept on a special computer because their normal computers can't deal with the numbers," he said at a Microsoft conference in Lisbon. "So I am constantly getting these notices telling me I haven't paid something when really it is just on the wrong computer," he added in comments on TV.

Gates' fortune is currently put at \$47 billion (Rs 2.2 lakh crore). But quit



bragging, Mr Gates... we all know even a 1982 computer with 48K of RAM running BASIC can handle 47*10^9!



Of Play And Porn

If we say the porn and gaming industries are converging, your reaction might range from "What is the world coming to?" to "About time!" Evergreen Events is to host the first Sex in Video Games Conference. An actual conference? Yes, and it's not about controversies: the two-day gathering will go into the details of the design and development—and also the "technology"—of sex in video games! The times, are they a-changing, or what? Amongst other things, the conference will feature an exhibit of "erotic machinima!"

Some quotes from those involved with the conference, which we found on Wired.com:

"The game industry needs to get smarter about how it treats sex—and related topics such as love, flirting, innuendo, passion, etc.—in games."

"2006 will see the release of many massively multiplayer online erotic games, or MMOEGs. Erotic gamers will be taken much closer to their ultimate fantasy."

"Recent technological innovation has made sexually explicit games more visually appealing."

"The Conference will give the adult entertainment industry and the games industry a place to talk and interact."

Nuff said!

"Humbler, Gentler"

She was chucked out of HP a long time ago, but she's still a globe-trotting celebrity speaker—and her speeches still cost \$50,000 each. Even then, according to *Mercury News*, Carly Fiorina is now humbler and gentler.

"Slowly, she's been admitting some mistakes she made while at the helm of HP," the paper said, referring to her speech material.

Rich Tehrani, who hired Fiorina to speak

at a conference, said, "She wanted to make sure we didn't call her the most powerful woman in the world... She seemed beyond humble. She's put on this pedestal by so many people, and yet is more humble than the person sitting next to you."

Being ousted from the Fortune list of the 50 most powerful women in 2005 probably makes humility and gentleness come easier...



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